

Nordic Timber Group — On-Site Audit Report

Facility:	Forest management units and sawmill, Värmland, Sweden
Audit type:	FSC Chain of Custody + labor compliance audit
Audit dates:	2026-03-02 to 2026-03-03 (2 days)
Auditor:	Meridian Assurance Partners (third-party)
Overall rating:	Satisfactory — Low Risk

Executive Summary

This audit found Nordic Timber Group to be in strong conformance with FSC Chain of Custody and labor compliance requirements. Only one minor administrative finding was raised, corrected the same day.

Chain of Custody

All 25 sampled timber lots were correctly traced back to FSC-certified forest management units, with harvest volumes for the audited period within the approved annual allowable cut. Two purchase order records were found missing their FSC claim codes; both were corrected by the facility's procurement team before the audit concluded.

Health & Safety

Facility incident records show zero lost-time injuries over the preceding three years, notably better than the sector average for forestry and sawmill operations. Chainsaw and forwarder operators sampled all held current certification and PPE compliance was observed at 100% across inspected harvest sites.

Environmental

A GPS-based survey of a sample of harvest blocks confirmed biodiversity buffer zones around waterways were maintained at or above the required width in all cases reviewed.

Worker Interview Summary

12 forestry and sawmill workers were interviewed across harvest and mill operations. All reported being paid on schedule and in line with the sector collective bargaining agreement. Seasonal workers interviewed (3 of the 12) confirmed they received the same safety training and PPE as permanent staff before starting harvest work.

Management Systems

The facility's FSC Chain of Custody procedures were last internally reviewed in 2025-11, with no gaps identified. Staff responsible for claim-code entry have been retrained following the two missing-code records noted above, and a secondary review step has been added to the purchase order approval workflow to catch similar omissions going forward.

Corrective Action Log

Finding	Severity	Due Date	Status
Purchase orders missing FSC claim codes (2 records)	Minor	Immediate	Closed — corrected on-site

Conclusion

Recommendation: continued certification with no follow-up audit required before the next scheduled annual audit (2027-03). Facility is commended for its safety record and chain-of-custody discipline.